

Awards

6th National Telecom Awards 2012

Communication, Multimedia & Infrastructure Association of India (CMAI) recently announced the 6th National Telecom Awards 2012 honouring lasting contributions made by IT and telecom companies for the betterment of telecommunication services in the country.

Winners included Akhil Gupta of Bharti Enterprises (CEO of the year in telecom), BSNL (best broadband and fixed-line operator), Bharti Airtel (best-quality mobile network services provider), Lava International (best mobile handset designing company), Radius Infratel (emerging ICT infrastructure provider), Bangalore International Airport (for excellence in dedicated ICT infrastructure), AMDOCS (for innovation in turnkey solutions products), Ericsson India (largest telecom equipment manufacturer) and Nokia Siemens Networks (best managed services vendor).

Kontron bags Editor's Choice Award by Military Embedded Systems magazine

Kontron's 18-blade, VPX-based, high-performance embedded computing (HPEC) platform has been selected for an editor's choice award by *Military Embedded Systems* magazine for its April-May 2012 issue. The platform was chosen because of its ability to meet military programmes' needs for high-end processing. This highly integrated HPEC platform was developed to supply an immense amount of power in a small footprint.

Emerson's Trellis platform recognised by Forrester report

Emerson Network Power has been recognised as a dominant supplier in data centre infrastructure management by Forrester Research Inc. Forrester's report highlights that Emerson Network Power's Trellis real-time infrastructure optimisation platform enables unified management of data centre IT and facilities infrastructure.

TI gives \$2.2 million to UC Berkeley

Texas Instruments (TI) has announced a \$2.2-million gift to support engineering education at the University of California, Berkeley. The university will use the gift to transform its traditional introductory Electronic Design Lab into a dynamic learning environment for undergraduate students. In addition to the monetary gift, TI is donating development kits that incorporate a range of devices from its extensive semiconductor portfolio, and supporting software, to enhance the hands-on learning experience in the classroom.

The announcements are part of TI's strategy of working with universities worldwide to help engineering students build a foundation of knowledge and experience with analogue and embedded processing technologies and excite them about the hardware side of electronics and engineering.

Visa and Obopay partner for near real-time payment

Visa and Obopay have collaborated to enable near-real-time payment solutions for disbursing electronic funds to a prepaid card. As a result of the agreement, Obopay will offer its partners the ability to disburse funds from their corporate account directly onto a Visa prepaid card which they have provided to a payee. The capability can be particularly valuable when recipients have an immediate need for funds.

Offering a Visa prepaid card as part of Obopay Disbursements allows consumers timely access to funds that can be used everywhere Visa debit cards are accepted. Use of Visa prepaid cards also allows businesses to send funds to any consumer, including those who don't have access to a traditional bank account.

Seagate to acquire controlling stake in LaCie

Seagate Technology, a hard disk drives and storage solutions provider, has

announced an exclusive agreement with the intent to acquire a controlling interest in LaCie.

The transaction would combine two highly complementary product and technology portfolios, adding LaCie's line of premium branded consumer storage solutions, network-attached storage solutions and software offerings to Seagate's array of mainstream consumer storage products. The combination would accelerate Seagate's growth strategy in the expanding consumer storage market, particularly in Europe and Japan, and add strong engineering and software development capabilities, as well as relationships with several key retailers.

Renesas planning to slash 6000 jobs

Renesas Electronics Corp., the world's biggest automotive microcontroller maker, is reportedly planning to cut its workforce by 6000 employees. The Japanese firm employs about 42,000 people worldwide. It is also mulling over raising 50 billion yen (\$630 million) in fresh capital, according to Japan's top-selling *Yomiuri Shimbun*.

The job cuts at Renesas will be mainly through voluntary retirements. Renesas, however, didn't comment on the *Yomiuri* report.

HP plans to cut 27,000 jobs

Hewlett-Packard (HP) is attempting to save its sinking boat by adopting a restructuring plan, cutting jobs, reviving the revenue and regaining the lost spirit. The company's chief executive officer Meg Whitman, with a view of revamping the consumer business, has introduced dramatic changes. She said, "While some of these actions are difficult because they involve the loss of jobs, they are necessary to improve execution and to fund the long-term health of the company."

HP is expected to generate savings of \$3 billion to \$3.5 billion from the 8 per cent cut of the company's workforce in the fiscal year 2014. These savings will be invested into R&D, which currently receives only 3 per cent of the sales.

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